



storage test

Did you know that some notebook drives consume under 3 W of power?

Network storage solutions

Network Access Storage devices come in various storage capacities and look similar to external desktop hard drives. The network connectivity isn't the only added component. Many of them come with features for streaming media and downloading files directly from the Internet. We got two such products – the WD My Book World Edition and the Iomega StorCenter ix2.

The Iomega network drive is compact and built like a tank. On the other hand, WD's My Book World Edition has gone with the classy look. The StorCenter ix2 has two external USB ports for expansion. The WD MyBook only comes with one.

Setting up these drives was not that much of a problem but might require some tweaking on your part to get it working with your network. Software was provided with both to simplify the process.

Both the network drives had remote access through a web inter-

	Western Digital MyBook World Ed	Iomega StorCenter ix2
4 GB File Write (sec)	496	689
4 GB File Read (sec)	478	450
4 GB Assorted Write (sec)	539	682
4 GB Assorted Read (sec)	518	509

face. The WD interface had a better looking interface than the Iomega. When it comes to features, the Iomega has slightly more to offer. Both the drives included user accounts, backup & recovery tools, remote access and media servers. The Iomega offers additional features such as printer setup, video surveillance as well as a BitTorrent downloader, where you can directly download your BitTorrent files into the drive. This is a big plus for the Iomega drive. It's absolutely amazing for those who want to download but don't want to keep a power-hogging PC running all day and night.

We tested the performance of this drive by transferring 4 GB of sequential as well as assorted data and noted down the read and write times. The WD drive was faster than the Iomega and gave us read as well as write times not exceeding nine minutes. Write times for the Iomega drive went up to 12 minutes.

Overall, the WD performed slightly better than the Iomega, the feature-set of the Iomega ix2 was more attractive. The Iomega ix2 is far more expensive at Rs. 23,000 than the WD MyBook World Edition which was priced at around Rs. 13,000.



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drives favoured the application loading tests whereas most of the Western Digital drives excelled at large capacity file transfers. Hitachi did well at the write tests, but was left behind when it came to the Photoshop file loading test.

If you're looking for a drive that you can use to run your operating system on, and cheap, then the slightly older WD Caviar Blue 3200AAKS is a good option. It doesn't match up to the scorching pace of the new drives; but priced at Rs. 4,000, it makes for a very good option. If you need a little more space, then the 500 GB Seagate 7200.11 should suit you better. It's almost the same as the WD 3200AAKS.

While the Velociraptor takes the throne for the fastest drive in the test, the one ranked after it is *better value-for-money*. The WD Black Edition 1-TB drive gives excellent performance and space unlike the 300 GB Velociraptor, for far less.

External portable hard drives

Of the seven portable drives we received, two were from Seagate. Unlike the desktop drives, where power-saving and reliability made up the different series offered, portable drives had no such classifications. All the portable drives performed similar to each other. It was only the Seagate FreeAgent Go that scored poorly in the internal file copy tests.

If design and appearance matters, then Seagate's drives look appealing. WD drives generally look alike, but they come in sober colours.

Western Digital's Studio line of drives came with a Firewire connectivity option. This didn't greatly enhance performance for most of the tests as expected, but there were a few improvements seen in the Photoshop file loading test. The WD's My Passport series enjoyed a tiny edge over the Seagate's FreeAgent Go lineup, but the price difference between the WD drives isn't justified if you're looking for performance. The WD My Passport Studio 250 GB makes the most

